YANG, XUETING

Department of Economics and Related Studies, University of York, York, YO10 5DD
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EDUCATION

09/2023 – 2027 (Expected) University of York, Department of Economics and Related Studies York, UK

Ph.D., Economics

Dissertation: *Individual decision-making in ambiguous (and risky) situations*
Expected thesis submission: November 2026

09/2020 – 03/2022 Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, International Business School Suzhou Suzhou, China

MSc, Economics and Finance (with Distinction)

09/2015 – 07/2019 Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, International Business School Suzhou Suzhou, China

BSc, Economics and Finance (with First-class Honours)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Experimental and Behavioural Economics, with a focus on decision-making under risk and ambiguity, beliefs and probability perception, consumer behaviour, and applied microeconomic theory.

PUBLICATIONS & PAPERS UNDER REVIEW

- Yang, X. (2026). **"Less Is More": Decision-Making under Increasingly Complex Ambiguity.** *Journal of Risk and Uncertainty.* https://doi.org/10.1007/s11166-026-09514-9 ***(Job Market Paper***)

  Investigates whether greater complexity in decisions under ambiguity requires more flexible behavioural models. Using laboratory experiments and individual-level model comparisons, the study finds that Expected Utility (EU) is most frequently preferred by AICc across three tasks, although Choquet Expected Utility (CEU) remains competitive in the most complex setting.

- Yang, X., & Hey, J. (2025). **Do workers maximize expected utility when choosing labour contracts under ambiguity?** *Journal of Risk and Uncertainty*, *71*(3), 273–292. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11166-025-09470-w

- Yang, X. (2026). **Model-Implied Probabilities in Blind Box Consumption: An Experimental Investigation** (*Major Revision, Theory and Decision*)

  Uses laboratory lottery valuations to recover model-implied probabilities of a rare high-value outcome under EU and RDEU, revealing substantial individual heterogeneity and meaningful dependence on the maintained preference specification.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Cognitive Ability and Belief Formation under Ambiguity

Examines how cognitive ability shapes the precision and calibration of subjective beliefs under ambiguity, using incentivised laboratory experiments and measures of risk and ambiguity preferences.

AWARDS & FUNDING

- *Departmental PhD Studentship Funding,* University of York, 2023-2027
- *2025-2026 Award for Outstanding Overseas Study Elite*, China Scholarship Council, 2026
- *Teaching Excellence Award*, University of York, 2025

CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

- 06/2026 *ASFEE 2026: Annual Conference of the French Association of Experimental Economics*, Lille, France. (Oral Presentation)
- 06/2026 *2026 CMID (conference on Mechanism and Institution Design)*, York, UK. (Member of local organization committee)
- 06/2026 *FUR (Foundations of Utility and Risk) Conference 2026*, Alicante, Spain. (Oral Presentation)
- 05/2026 *2026 Durham-Edinburgh-York Workshop*, Durham, UK. (Oral Presentation)
- 03/2026 *ECO Department Brownbag Seminar*, Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, Suzhou, China. (Presenter)
- 10/2025 *Departmental Thursday Workshop*, University of York, York, UK. (Presenter)
- 06/2025 *ASFEE 2025: 15th Conference of the French Experimental Economics Association*, Nancy, France. (Oral Presentation & Poster session)
- 06/2025 *ESA 2025 World Meeting*, Beijing, China. (Oral Presentation)
- 08/2024 *2024 SABE/IAREP Conference*, Dundee, UK. (Poster Session)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of York, Department of Economics and Related Studies York, UK

Teaching Assistant

Microeconomic Theory (Undergraduate), 09/2024 – 02/2026

- Led tutorials on core microeconomic concepts and problem-solving; supported students' analytical and mathematical reasoning and provided feedback on assessed work.

Probability and Statistics (Undergraduate), 02/2025 – 06/2025

- Delivered small-group tutorials on probability and statistical methods, guiding students in applying theoretical concepts to practical problems.

Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, International Business School Suzhou Suzhou, China

Teaching Assistant

Experimental Economics and Finance (Undergraduate), 09/2021 – 12/2021

- Supported classroom experiments by explaining procedures and economic concepts, facilitating discussions, and guiding students in interpreting experimental outcomes.

TECHNICAL SKILLS & LANGUAGE

- **Software & Programming**
  - **Experimental programming:** Visual Studio (VB.NET/.NET), z-Tree; developed custom Windows Forms applications for risk/ambiguity elicitation, BDM mechanisms, and complexity treatments.
  - **Quantitative analysis:** MATLAB, R, Stata; behavioural data analysis and econometric modelling.
- **Languages** Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent), Japanese (basic), Thai (beginner)

REFERENCES

Professor John Hey
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